Nanxi Fu

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Citizenship: Chinese

Research Interests: Industrial Organization, Urban Economics, Quantitative Marketing

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Toronto — 2027 (Expected)
Committee: Yao Luo (Co-supervisor), Matthew Osborne (Co-supervisor), Nathaniel Baum-Snow

M.A in Economics, University of Toronto — 2021

B.A Joint Honours in Economics and Mathematics, McGill University — 2020

Research

Assortment Policy: How Far Can It Move Consumption? (Job Market Paper)

Would Consumers Do Grocery Shopping Differently with Better Vehicle Access?

An Investigation of Heterogeneous Treatment Effects (Pre-Doctoral Work, Undergrad Research Project)

Awards and Grants

Department of Economics PhD Conference Travel Grant, University of Toronto — 2026
Student Travel Grant, Canadian Economic Association — 2026
University of Toronto Doctoral Fellowship, University of Toronto — 2021-Present
Silver Medal Team, Econometric Game, with Tom Stringham (Captain) and Atom Vayalinkal — 2022
Faculty of Arts and Sciences Graduate Admission Award, University of Toronto — 2020
Brian Coghlan Memorial Prize in Economics, McGill University — 2020
Dean's Honours List, McGill University — 2017
James McGill Entrance Scholarship, McGill University — 2016

Professional Experience

Course Instructor, University of Toronto — 2025

- ECO220: Introduction to Data Analysis and Applied Econometrics

Teaching Assistant, University of Toronto — 2020-Present

- ECO101: Introductory Microeconomics
- ECO200: Microeconomics Theory
- ECO202: Macroeconomic Theory and Policy
- ECO220: Introduction to Data Analysis and Applied Econometrics
- ECO380: Markets, Competition, and Strategy

Research Assistant — 2019 - 2026

- Matthew Osborne: Advanced data processing, spatial analysis (GIS), interviews, drafting *The Economic Impact of Independent and Franchised Grocers in Canada 2025*
- Aradhya Sood: Advanced data processing, spatial analysis (GIS), fuzzy string matching, regression and structural estimation, and RA supervision
- Jiaying Gu: Monte-Carlo Simulations, Literature Review
- Saraswata Chaudhuri: Literature Review, Paper Replication, data processing

Conference Presentations

Annual Conference of EARIE (Mannheim) — 2026
Annual Conference of the Canadian Economics Association (Vancouver) — 2026

Languages

Mandarin (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)
Programming: Stata, Python, QGIS, MATLAB, Julia, Java, R

References

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Abstracts

Assortment Policy: How Far Can It Move Consumption?

(Job Market Paper)

This paper explores whether assortment targeted policy such as a mandate on fresh produce assortment requirement can increase consumers purchase of fresh produce, as the upcoming November 2026 SNAP updates on retailers stocking requirements follow the same rationale. This paper develops a nested demand model incorporating how consumers choose across stores and divide expenditure across categories. Combining store-level assortment information and consumer purchase data on nine categories of food products, estimates of the model show that assortment can change how much consumers decide to spend in store within each category. However, assortment has limited impacts on categorical level expenditure, given the estimated elasticities at outer layer for all categories are almost unit elastic. The counterfactual shows a similar story that for a mandate targeted on increasing fresh produce assortment for low-stocking stores, it changes where consumers purchase their fresh produce but move little their total consumption for fresh produce. This suggests that future policy should targets on shifting preference at product category level.

Would Consumers Do Grocery Shopping Differently with Better Vehicle Access?

This paper explores how zipcode-level vehicle ownership can relate to consumers' grocery shopping demands in terms of the bundle purchased, frequency of shopping and size of bundles. For households living in regions with 0.1 more likely to have at least one vehicle access, households on average shop 2.1 percent fewer trips to form an average 1000-dollar bundle. This result suggests less frequent shopping and larger bundles in terms of quantity and variety for households that are more likely to have vehicles. This result can also be related to the patterns of these households are more likely to purchase more non-perishable products. The mechanism behind these characteristics can be related to the different quality of stores in terms of the number of varieties supplied around the households. There is no evidence in the data that consumers with better vehicle access can carry more products or search less to pay higher prices for the same products. The role of vehicles in consumers' grocery shopping can have important policy implications on the food desert issues.